The "secure password" story you defined earlier went like this:

```
Story: Providing a secure password when registering
In order to avoid hackers compromising member accounts
As the systems administrator
I want new members to provide a secure password when they register
```

You also had an initial set of acceptance criteria:

- The password should be at least 8 characters.
- The password should contain at least 1 digit.
- The password should contain at least 1 punctuation mark.
- I should get an error message telling me what I did wrong if I enter an insecure password.

These acceptance criteria are a good start, but there are still some potential ambiguities. Can you have all lowercase characters, or do you need a mixture of uppercase and lowercase? Does the position of the number in the password matter? How detailed should the error message be?

When you talk to the systems administrator about this story, you could use examples to try to clarify these questions and others (because you certainly haven't thought of everything). You can use a few key examples as the basis for your formal acceptance criteria (we'll discuss how to express acceptance criteria in a more structured way in the next chapter). Not all of the examples that you'll discover in these conversations will make it into the scenarios—many will just be useful to guide the conversation and expand your understanding of the problem space.

This sort of conversation is more productive if you use some simple strategies. Remember, the aim of this exercise is to build a mental model of the requirements and to illustrate this mental model with a number of key examples. Think of the problem space for the story as a set of jigsaw puzzle pieces. When you ask for an example, you're really asking for clarification of your understanding of the requirements. This is like picking up a piece of the jigsaw and placing it where you think it should go. If it fits, you've confirmed your understanding and expanded your mental model. If it doesn't, then you've flushed out an incorrect assumption and can move forward on a more solid basis.

Back to our password scenario. Raj the System Administrator is an expert in system security and knows a great deal about what makes a secure password. Raj is very concerned about this problem, as in his experience most users naturally use passwords that are very easy to hack. To clarify the exact requirements, you take Susan, a tester, and Joe, a developer, along to see Raj to learn more about what he needs. The conversation with Raj goes along the following lines:

> You: I'd like to make sure I've understood what you need for the "secure password" story. The first acceptance criteria we defined is about password length. So a password should be rejected if it has less than 8 characters?